

Three-Page Column Order Test

1. Page One

Page one is a plain two-column body with nothing spanning the grid. A parser should read the whole left column before the whole right column. This paragraph exists to give the first column enough lines to be unambiguous.

The second paragraph of page one continues the left column. Extraction should keep these two together and in order before

moving across the gutter to the right-hand side of the page.

The right column of page one carries on the same section. If the order is correct this text appears after both paragraphs above, never interleaved between them.

A fourth paragraph closes page one so that both columns are comfortably filled and the layout is unambiguous to any reasonable segmentation routine.

2. Page Two

Page two repeats the structure of page one so that the document has a stable two-column grid throughout. Nothing on this page spans both columns.

A second paragraph gives the left column of page two enough material to be clearly distinguishable from the right column beside

it.

The right column of page two begins here. Correct output reads this after the two paragraphs on the left, not between them.

A closing paragraph balances the two columns of page two before the document moves on to the page that actually matters for this test.

3. Page Three

Page three is the interesting one. Its two-column body is interrupted near the bottom by a full-width figure, and it also contains a generous section break in the middle of the body. A parser that reacts to the figure by cutting the page at its widest horizontal gap will slice through the middle of the two-column body instead, and then read the top of column one, the top of column two, the bottom of column one and the bottom of column two in that order.

This second paragraph keeps the upper half of the left column busy so that the interleaving, if it happens, is obvious in the extracted order rather than subtle.

3.1 After A Wide Gap



Figure 2: A full-width figure at the foot of page three. It spans both columns and so breaks any single column split for the page.

The heading above is preceded by a deliberately large gap. On a page whose columns are otherwise uninterrupted this is the widest horizontal channel that crosses the full width, which is exactly what makes it a trap.

The lower half of the left column continues here. In the correct reading order this paragraph follows the one above it and precedes everything in the right column.

The upper half of the right column starts here. It must come after every paragraph of the left column, including the ones below the wide gap.

A further right-column paragraph keeps the upper right area populated so both halves of the page have content on both sides.

The lower right column closes the two-column body of page three, immediately above the full-width figure that interrupts the grid.